



AND THEN ALL NED BROOK LOOSE—This scene, involving Frankie Robinson (20), Gene Conley, left, Coach Andy Cohen (39) and Reds' pitcher Raul Sanchez (35) and Phillies' manager Gene Mauch, obscured by Robinson and Cohen, was the start of a wild melee in eighth inning of opener at Crosley Field yesterday. Sanchez had hit two batters and walked a third and when he hit the fourth batter Mauch charged onto the playing field. Robinson grabbed Mauch, trying to keep him away from Sanchez. Conley slugged Cincinnati's Billy Martin (12) shown back of Cohen. Subsequently, fights broke out all over the infield. (AP Wirephoto).

Martin Claims Gene Conley Hit Him with 'Sucker Punch'

CINCINNATI (AP)—Billy Martin, a good second baseman, has been trying to live down his reputation as a brawler. He's trying a comeback with Cincinnati's Reds.

But the fists were flying again Sunday and this time Martin was tagged, he says, trying to be a peacemaker.

"I never figured I'd get hit breaking up a fight," said the former American Leaguer. "Sucker punched—that's what it was."

Billy said pitcher Gene Conley gave him the wallop. His pride was also hurt and he wants a return engagement with Conley.

It came during the biggest free-for-all brawl seen in Crosley Field in years, in the eighth inning of the first of two Reds' games with Philadelphia.

The Phils were far ahead and went on to win, 14-3. Cincinnati won the more sedate nightcap, 5-1.

Reds reliever Raul Sanchez had trouble finding the plate and three times he hit Philly batters with low, erratic pitches. The third one hit Conley.

Philly Manager Gene Mauch charged at Sanchez, fire in his eye. Redleg first baseman Frank Robinson drifted over to intercept Mauch. So did Martin.

"All I did is try to intercept him," said Martin. "I grabbed him, but from behind, somebody slugs me."

"I turn around and it's Conley. Brave, isn't he. Sucker punching."

Mauch tangled with pitcher Sanchez and that emptied the dugouts of both teams. Fist-fighting started in earnest and relief pitchers streaked in from the bullpen to help.

For 12 minutes the brawlers roved around the field, rassing

and punching on the ground in groups of four or five, or squaring off, man to man. Finally peacemakers prevailed.

Robinson found himself on the bottom of a pile of three Philly players at one point.

Later he and Philly pitcher Robin Roberts tangled in a private punching match and had to be separated.

But Roberts apologized to Robinson saying, "I made a remark

I shouldn't have made. I was mad at the time."

Umpires finally cleared the field and ordered all the players off the field except those in the game. None were ejected, however.

And Billy Martin, who has tried to turn away from his brawling days, was the only combatant visibly hurt. The punch raised a big swelling where Martin's jaw was broken by a pitch last year. X-rays later showed no break.

Phillies Win Respect Despite Road Record

PHILADELPHIA (AP) — The Philadelphia Phillies open a long home stand beginning with St. Louis tonight after a 17-day road trip on which they won 6 games while losing 10.

Despite the below average road showing the Phillies picked up considerable respect along the way.

Manager Bill Rigney of the San Francisco Giants summed up the feelings of several other National League managers when he said: "How those Phillies have changed."

And Phillies' manager Gene Mauch sees an improvement in the defense.

"We stopped giving away runs," he said Sunday after the Phillies split a doubleheader with the Cincinnati Reds, taking the opener marked by a free-for-all, 14-3, but losing the nightcap 5-1.

"We're making them earn every-

thing they get," Mauch added, referring to the rival clubs.

The Phillies bombed five Reds' pitchers for 15 hits in the opener, including homers by Tony Curry, John Callison, Pancho Herrera and Cal Neenan, to back up Gene Conley in his first victory this year. Cal McLish was the loser.

Big Don Newcombe, making his first start since May 1, held the Phillies in check pretty well until the seventh when he weakened, giving up a double to Herrera and a single to Harry Anderson for the Phils' lone run. Bill Henry came on to save the victory.

The hitting of Frank Robinson and Gus Bell sparked the Reds in the nightcap and sent Humberto Robinson down to defeat. Robinson and Bell each belted homers. Bell doubled in two runs and scored himself on a single by Robinson.

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